



SAMSON AND DELILAH

Saint-Saëns's most famous opera, premiered in Weimar in 1877, has many colorful scenes, including a dance of priestesses, here depicted by French artist Pierre Carrier-Belleuse.

Prolific composer

Saint-Saëns's vast output included symphonies, concertos, operas (of which *Samson and Delilah* is the best known), religious and secular choral music, tone poems (notably *Danse Macabre*, which uses a xylophone to evoke rattling bones), chamber music, songs, solo compositions for piano and organ, and even music for the cinema. Ironically, his most popular work today is probably the witty and satirical *Carnival of the Animals* (1886), which was written as a joke and not published during his lifetime.

Saint-Saëns's music is notable for its elegance, refinement, and